

Nobody Assigned This

Skill focus: Initiative / Self-Starting · (lightly touches Decomposition)

Name _____

Class _____

Date _____

Most of school waits for someone to tell you what to do next. This doesn't. Your job is to find a problem nobody handed you and *move on it* — and to investigate before you ask for help. Part of your grade is what you tried before you raised your hand.

Step 1 — Spot it. Name one real, unassigned problem worth solving in this room, this school, or your community. ("The recycling overflows by Thursday." "Newcomers can't find the library.") (*Early on, your teacher gives you a menu. By the end, you find your own.*)

Step 2 — Try three before you ask. Before any hand goes up:

1. Re-read / re-look at what you already know
2. Try a different approach
3. Look it up

Write down what each try told you. *Then* — if you still need help — ask a precise question: "*I tried X and Y, so my real question is Z.*"

Step 3 — Propose the next step. Don't stop at "I'm stuck." Write at least one concrete next step. Later, write **two or three options** and pick the most promising.

Step 4 — Take a first action. Actually do a small version of that step *right now* — a draft, a one-line email, a quick sketch, a five-minute experiment. Small and fast. This is about the *start*, not a finished project.

Step 5 — Report. In one or two sentences: "*Here's what I tried, and here's what I'll try next.*" That sentence is the whole skill.
